CS 2308.R7 Spring 2026 Syllabus

Instructor: Dr. Xiaomin Li
Office Location: Avery 464N
Email Address: xminli@txstate.edu (Email subject starts with CS2308-xxxx)
Office Hours: Tuesday 11:00 AM – 12:20 PM, 3:30 – 4:30 PM in person at Avery 464N. Other times, or if requesting Zoom meetings, please send me emails and make appointments.

Time and Place of Class Meetings: T TR, 14 PM - 15:20 PM
Location: Avery 00362

Students are encouraged to bring laptops or tablets that can access the Internet in the class to submit quizzes or finish in-class coding practice.

Description of Course Content:
The course is an introduction to Abstract Data Types (ADTs) including lists, stacks, and queues. Searching and sorting, pointers and dynamic memory allocation, and simple classes and objects also will be covered. The course is a continuation of CS 1428.

Prerequisite(s): CS 1428 with a grade of "C" or better.

Course objectives:
1. An in-depth understanding of structured programming in terms of modules and functions.
2. An in-depth understanding of pointers and memory operations.
3. An introduction to linked-lists in terms of concept, implementation, and operations.
4. An introduction to Data Structures, including Stacks and Queues.
5. An introduction to classes and object-oriented programming.
6. Ability to program in the Linux environment.
7. Algorithm development. Develop fluency in the development of algorithms. Comparing different algorithms for the same task (for example, searching & sorting).
8. Testing and debugging code.

Course Materials:
Class slides and source code provided by the instructor.

Required Textbook:
Starting Out with C++ from Control Structures to Objects 9th Edition, Tony Gaddis ISBN-13: 9780134996066

Coding Practice Textbook: ZyBook
Sign in or create an account at learn.zybooks.com (Use your TXST email to register)

Enter zyBook code: TXSTATECS2308liFall2025
Subscribe: $89

NOTE: If you have enrolled into the BookSmart program, you should get this textbook without additional fees.

During the first few weeks, you may experience delays in receiving your ZyBooks access code if you are using the Bookstore Program. In the meantime, you can use the following link to get a 30-day free trial while waiting for your access code.

https://support.zybooks.com/hc/en-us/articles/360007439574-How-to-request-a-temporary-subscription-to-a-zyBook#:~:text=prepaid%20access%20keys.-,How%20to%20request%20a%20temporary%20subscription,-Start%20by%20goingLinks to an external site.

	Topic	Dates
Unit 1	Functions, Arrays & Structs	Week 2
	Linux, Git	Week 3
Unit 2	Searching, Sorting & Analysis	Week 4, 5
Unit 3	Pointers & Dynamic Memory Allocation	Week 6, 7
Midterm	Review, Exam	Week 8
Unit 4	Intro to Classes	Week 9, 10
Unit 5	Linked Lists	Week 11, 12

Unit 6	Stacks & Queues	Week 13, 14
Add'I	STD, Template, Copy Constructor	Week 15
	Review	Week 15
Final	Exam	Week 16

Grading:

Attendance: 5%
Quizzes and Coding Practices: 25%
Programming Assignments: 30%
Midterm Exam: 20%
Final Exam: 20%

Final grade scales:

A: 100%~89.50%

B: 89.49%~79.50%

C: 79.49%~69.50%

D: 69.49%~59.50%

F: Below 59.49%

Quizzes and Coding Practices will be given on Canvas. Students need to finish them within the day of class. Students are encouraged to practice coding in class. Extra points will be given to students who actively participate in in-class practice.

There will be **4-5 programming assignments**. Instructions will be posted on Canvas.

Midterm Exam and **Final Exam** are paper-based (Tentative, may change to online). You may expect to write some code segments on paper. The midterm exam will cover Units 1 – 3, and the final exam will mainly focus on Units 4 – 6, but some content in Units 1 – 3 will be used to answer the questions.

Class Attending Policy and Homework Policy:

We will use the **Top Hat** classroom response system in class to take attendance. You can receive full credit for Class Participation if you attend more than 80% of the classes in person. You can receive half credit for Class Participation if you attend 50% ~ 80% of the classes in person. You will receive zero credit for Class Participation if you attend less than 50% of the classes in person. Do not come to class late.

All assignments are to be done individually. You may discuss general strategies for solving assignment problems with other students in the class and you may help each other debug, but you must write your own code.
Late assignments will incur a 10% penalty per day, for up to 3 days. After the 3 days, no submission will be accepted. (If you have some special reasons, late assignment submissions are accepted till the end of the semester with a 40% penalty. You will need to ask for this special extension beforehand and I may deny your request.)

Make-up Exams:
Make-up exams will be allowed only to students that were not able to take the original exam due to a health condition justified by the related paperwork from a doctor. Absence due to other reasons will be graded with zero.

Drop Policy:
You must follow the withdrawal and drop policy set up by the University and the College of Science. You are responsible for checking the drop deadlines and making sure that the drop process is complete.
https://www.registrar.txst.edu/registration/ac/academic-calendar.html
***Students will not be automatically dropped for non-attendance.**

Accommodations for students with disability:
Any student with a special need requiring special accommodations should inform me during the first two weeks of classes. The student should also contact the office of disability services at the LBJ student center.

Use of AI Policy:

Definition. “AI” means large language models and LLM-powered tools (e.g., ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, GitHub Copilot, CodeWhisperer) used to explain, draft, or generate text or code.

Allowed (limited use). You may use AI to:

- clarify concepts or terminology;
- brainstorm approaches or test ideas;
- view small illustrative code snippets for learning (do not submit them);
- get suggestions for debugging or fixing compile/runtime errors;
- polish grammar and wording of your own writing.

Not allowed. You may not:

- use AI to obtain or submit answers to any assignment, lab, or project;
- use AI to write any part of the code you submit;
- copy, adapt, or “heavily edit” AI-generated code or solutions and present them as your own;
- enable AI auto-completion/assistant extensions in your IDE while working on graded code (turn them off);
- use any AI tools during quizzes, tests, or exams.

Disclosure. If you consult AI for allowed purposes, briefly note it in your submission (tool name, prompt/task, how you used the output). Example: “Used ChatGPT to clarify xxxxx algorithm invariants; no code used.”

Responsibility. You are fully responsible for the correctness, originality, and academic integrity of your work. You must be able to explain any submitted solution in detail.

Enforcement. Submitting AI-generated work (in whole or in part) or using prohibited AI during assessments is academic misconduct. Consequences may include a zero on the assignment and referral under university policy.

Academic Honesty:
You are expected to adhere to both the University's Academic Honor Code as described here: http://www.txstate.edu/effective/upps/upps-07-10-01.html, as well as the Computer Science Department Honor Code, described here: 2013 0426 HonestyPolicy CSPPS.doc.

- Except where explicitly and specially allowed (such as group projects), all work submitted in the class is expected to be your individual work. Plagiarism will not be tolerated and if detected will result in an automatic "F" grade.
- Do not include code (or other materials) obtained from the Internet in your assignments (except what is provided or allowed by the instructor).
- Do not email your program to anyone (except your partner or the instructor).
- The penalty for submitting a program that has been derived from the internet or any other

non-approved source will be a 0 for that assignment. Violators will be reported to the Texas State Honor Code Council (http://www.txstate.edu/honorcodecouncil/).

Free Resources for Students

- **txstate.edu -> News, Job Announcements, Lab and Tutoring Announcements (@txstCS)**
- **LinkedIn Learning:** https://doit.txstate.edu/services/online-training.html
- **Food Insecurity: Bobcat Bounty** is the first student-run, on-campus food pantry at Texas State University. It is run by students with the goal to decrease food insecurity by providing healthy food to the students, faculty, and administration at Texas State University https://bobcatbounty.txstate.edu
- **Texas State Counseling Center:** Counseling Center services ***are free, confidential, and provided by trained professionals*** to currently enrolled Texas State students while classes are in session. https://www.counseling.txstate.edu/
- **Texas State Sexual Misconduct Policy and Reporting:** If you need to make a report, please contact Alexandria Hatcher, Title IX Coordinator, at 512.245.2539 or you can file a report for someone else, anonymously, or using a pseudonym here: https://compliance.txstate.edu/oeotix/
- **Discrimination Complaints:** Texas State prohibits discrimination and harassment based on race, color, national origin, age, sex, religion, disability, veterans' status, sexual orientation, gender identity, or gender expression: https://www.txstate.edu/oei/policies/complaints.html
- **Office of Student Diversity and Inclusion:** https://www.sdi.txstate.edu/
    - Texas State Alliance: https://twitter.com/TxstAlliance
    - https://www.sdi.txstate.edu/Support-and-Empowerment/LGBTQIA-and-Allies.html
- **Full List of On-Campus Resources:**

https://www.studentsuccess.txstate.edu/programs/faces/On-Campus-Resources.html

- **Search Student Organizations:** https://www.lbjsc.txstate.edu/soc/join/search-orgs.html